

SILENT LATTICE



Silent Whisper

*Administrator Guide — organizations, workspaces,
membership, and trust.*

Administrator Guide · Edition 1.0

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1 Who This Guide Is For

This guide is for anyone with administrative responsibility in Silent Whisper: a **System Administrator** overseeing the whole deployment, an **Organization Administrator** managing membership across an organization, or a **Workspace Owner** or **Manager** running a team's day-to-day workspace. It covers what each of these roles can do, how membership and invitations work, and the trust and audit model underpinning the platform.

For everyday messaging features, see the companion **User Guide** — this guide focuses strictly on administrative capability.

CORE PRINCIPLE

Silent Whisper separates *structural* administration from *content* access. Administering a workspace's membership and settings never, by itself, grants access to the private conversations inside it. This distinction shapes almost every rule in this guide, and is explained fully in Chapter 10.

2 Roles & Permissions

Administrative authority in Silent Whisper is layered, and each layer's authority stops at its own boundary:

System Admin Global — spans every organization and workspace.

Org Admin / Org Member One organization.

Owner / Manager / Member One workspace.

Channel member One channel.

ROLE	SCOPE	PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITIES
System Administrator	Entire deployment	Create organizations; create and manage user accounts; oversee every workspace structurally; configure AI settings; review the audit log.
Organization Administrator	One organization	Invite, remove, and change the role of organization members.
Organization Member	One organization	No administrative permissions.
Workspace Owner	One workspace (exactly one Owner at a time)	Full control of the workspace: settings, visibility, membership, roles, ownership transfer.
Workspace Manager	One workspace	Manages plain members (invite, roster, password reset, removal); may archive the workspace only if the Owner has granted that specifically.
Workspace Member	One workspace	Ordinary participant; no administrative permissions.
Channel member	One channel	Any member may rename the channel, add or remove other members of a private channel, or leave.

NOTE

Organization membership has no "last admin" safeguard by design — an organization can end up with zero Org Administrators if the last one is removed or leaves. Keep this in mind when restructuring org-level access.

3 System Administration

Creating organizations

Only a System Administrator can create a new organization. Its creator becomes that organization's first Organization Administrator.

Creating and managing user accounts

Silent Whisper has no public sign-up — every account is created directly by a System Administrator, or arrives through an invitation (Chapter 7). System Administrators can:

- Create a new user account.
- Disable or re-enable an account — disabling takes effect immediately, ending any active session and blocking further sign-in right away, not just once a session naturally expires.
- Promote or demote System Administrator status for any user.
- Reset any user's password.
- See which organizations a given user belongs to.

Cross-workspace oversight

A System Administrator can view every workspace across every organization, and manage a workspace's structure — settings, archiving, visibility, membership and roles, channels, and ownership — even without being a member of it. This is the "structural override" referenced throughout this guide.

IMPORTANT

Using the structural override to manage a workspace does *not* grant a System Administrator access to its private channels or direct messages, and it does not add them as a member of any channel. To actually read conversation content, a System Administrator must take a further, separate, and audited step — the same one any other outsider would need. Structural oversight and content access are kept deliberately apart.

4 Organization Management

Organization Administrators manage who belongs to the organization and what role they hold there:

- **Invite or add members** to the organization.
- **Remove members** from the organization.
- **Change a member's role** between Organization Administrator and Organization Member.
- **Rename** the organization.
- **Archive** the organization when it's no longer active — archiving blocks new members, invitations, and workspaces from being added underneath it, while keeping it browsable for historical reference. Archiving can be reversed.

Any organization member — administrator or not — can leave the organization on their own at any time, without needing anyone's approval.

5 Workspace Management

Creating a workspace

Any authenticated user may create a workspace for themselves — this is self-service and doesn't require administrator approval. The creator automatically becomes its Owner.

Visibility

A workspace can be **discoverable** (visible in a browsable list that any user can search and request to join) or kept **private** (findable only by direct invitation). The Owner can change this at any time.

Membership & roles

Owners and Managers can invite or add members. Owners additionally control promotion and demotion between Manager and plain Member. Only an Owner can promote someone to Manager or remove Manager status.

Delegating archive rights

By default, only the Owner can archive or unarchive a workspace. An Owner can delegate that ability to Managers if they want day-to-day operational control to include archiving — this is an explicit setting, not a default.

Renaming a workspace

Owners and Managers can rename a workspace at any time.

Transferring ownership

Ownership can be transferred to another member of the workspace. This is the only way an Owner can leave their own workspace — Silent Whisper requires a workspace to always have exactly one Owner, so leaving without transferring first isn't possible.

Archiving a workspace

Archiving a workspace blocks new members, invitations, and channels, while preserving its history for browsing. It's reversible.

6 Channel Management

Channel management is deliberately lightweight — treated as ordinary participation rather than a special privilege, on the reasoning that anyone trusted enough to be in a channel is trusted enough to help run it:

- **Creating a channel** — any workspace member can create a new channel, public or private.
- **Renaming** — any current member of a channel can rename it.
- **Adding members to a private channel** — any current member can add another workspace member.
- **Removing a member** from a channel — removes them from that channel only, without affecting their workspace membership.
- **Leaving** — any member can leave a channel at any time, independent of their workspace membership.

NOTE

Public channels are self-joinable by any workspace member — no one needs to add them. Private channels require an existing member to add the person; the channel is invisible to everyone else, including in search and browsing.

7 Member Lifecycle & Invitations

Two ways to invite

METHOD	HOW IT WORKS
Invitation link	A shareable link created by an inviter. Whoever redeems it supplies their own details at that time. The inviter can revoke the link before it's used.
In-app invitation	Sent to a specific, already-registered user by name. It appears to them as a notification they can Accept or Decline — no link required.

Resetting a member's password

A workspace administrator (Owner or Manager) can reset the password of a member within their workspace; a System Administrator can reset any user's password organization-wide. There is no self-service, email-based password reset — this is by design.

Removing a member

Workspace administrators can remove a member from the workspace; members can also always remove themselves (Chapter 5). Removal from a workspace does not automatically remove someone from their parent organization, and vice versa — each layer is managed independently.

8 AI Settings

The AI features described in the User Guide (channel summaries, task extraction, workspace digests, and semantic search) are configured centrally, and only a System Administrator can change that configuration — no workspace-level role can. Configurable settings include:

- Which AI provider and model are in use.
- The endpoint the platform connects to for AI processing.
- Request timeouts and response length limits.
- Whether responses stream incrementally or arrive all at once.
- The prompt version in use.

WHY THIS IS CENTRALIZED

AI configuration was tightened to System-Administrator-only after a review found that certain workspace-level roles could otherwise reach settings with broader security implications than intended (including where AI requests are allowed to be sent). Keeping this single-purpose and centrally owned closes that gap.

9 Audit Log & Compliance

Silent Whisper keeps a standing audit log of administrative and security-relevant actions — account creation and changes, role and ownership changes, workspace and organization lifecycle events, authentication events, and access to the audit log itself.

Reviewing the log

System Administrators can browse recent audit events from the administration area, in reverse-chronological order.

Verifying integrity

Each entry in the audit log is cryptographically linked to the one before it, so any attempt to alter or remove a past entry breaks the chain in a detectable way. A one-click **Verify Integrity** action re-checks the entire chain on demand. The underlying database also enforces that log entries can never be updated, deleted, or bulk-erased — even by the application itself — so the log's append-only guarantee doesn't depend on any one piece of code behaving correctly.

NOTE

Viewing the audit log and running an integrity check are themselves logged — reviewing the log leaves a record of the review.

10 Security & Privacy Principles

Structural management is not content access

This is the single most important idea in this guide. Being able to administer a workspace's settings, membership, or channel list never by itself grants the ability to read the messages inside its private channels or direct messages. Anyone — including a System Administrator — who wants to read content they aren't already a participant in must take a further, explicit, and audited step to do so.

Private resources are invisible, not just restricted

If you're not a member of a private workspace or channel, Silent Whisper treats it as though it doesn't exist for you, rather than showing it and refusing access. This prevents someone from learning that a sensitive project or conversation exists at all, just by trying to access it.

Account security

- **Disabling an account takes effect immediately** — any live connection is closed at once, and re-authentication is blocked, rather than waiting for a session to expire naturally.
- **Session hijacking protection** — if a previously used sign-in credential is ever replayed after it should have expired, Silent Whisper treats this as a sign of compromise and signs out every other active session for that user automatically.
- **Password requirements** — new passwords must meet a minimum length and are checked against a list of known-compromised passwords.

Rate limiting

Sign-in attempts, message sending, invitation redemption, and AI feature requests are all automatically rate-limited to protect the platform from abuse and overload. This runs continuously in the background and doesn't require any administrator configuration or monitoring.

11 Best Practices Checklist

- ☐ Assign a second Organization Administrator wherever possible — there's no built-in safeguard against an organization ending up with zero.
- ☐ Transfer workspace ownership deliberately, and confirm the new Owner is who you intend before an existing Owner steps away — ownership is unique and consequential.
- ☐ Prefer in-app invitations for people who already have an account, and reserve invitation links for genuinely new people — links can be shared further than intended before they're redeemed.
- ☐ Revoke an invitation link as soon as it's no longer needed.
- ☐ Review the audit log periodically, not only when investigating something specific — a quiet regular habit catches more than a reactive one.
- ☐ Remember that structural oversight of a workspace is not the same as reading its content — don't rely on administrative access as a substitute for actually being a member of a channel you need visibility into.
- ☐ Archive organizations and workspaces that are no longer active rather than leaving them live and unmonitored — archiving is reversible and keeps active membership lists meaningful.

12 Role Capability Matrix

CAPABILITY	SYSTEM ADMIN	ORG ADMIN	WORKSPACE OWNER	WORKSPACE MANAGER	MEMBER
Create organization	Yes	—	—	—	—
Create user account	Yes	—	—	—	—
Disable / enable account	Yes	—	—	—	—
Invite / remove org members	Yes	Yes	—	—	—
Create workspace	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Change workspace visibility	Yes*	—	Yes	—	—
Invite / add workspace members	Yes*	—	Yes	Yes	—
Promote / demote Manager	Yes*	—	Yes	—	—
Transfer workspace ownership	Yes*	—	Yes	—	—
Archive workspace	Yes*	—	Yes	If delegated	—
Create / rename channel	Yes*	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
Add/remove private channel members	Yes*	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
Leave workspace / org / channel	Yes	Yes	After ownership transfer	Yes	Yes
Read private channel / DM content	Only if a member	Only if a member	Only if a member	Only if a member	Only if a member
Configure AI settings	Yes	—	—	—	—
View / verify audit log	Yes	—	—	—	—

* Via the structural override, without becoming a member and without gaining content access — see Chapter 10.



SILENT WHISPER

Administered with the same restraint it asks of everyone else.